Individually and collectively, BRICS governments have approached the problem of dollar dominance from multiple vantage points. Some BRICS countries are in favor of increasing the number of reserve currencies.[147] For at least a decade, Russia has been one of the strongest proponents of increasing the international role of the ruble; in 2003, it set the goal of making the ruble "freely tradable" in connection with Russia's entry into the G8. A second idea, initially promoted by China and Russia, that gained collective support was to create a supranational reserve currency that would transform the SDR. In 2009, Russia tabled both proposals to the G20 meeting in London, emphasizing the need for the expansion and diversification of reserve currencies and the development of "major regional financial centers."[148]

At the 2010 BRICS summit in Brasilia, the BRICS agreed to explore monetary cooperation, including using national currencies in trade. Russia and China began to hold auctions in yuan and rubles the following year, while Brazil also emphasized shifting toward bilateral trade in national currencies and including the real in the foreign exchange reserves of other states. After the G20 summit in Los Cabos, Mexico, in 2012, Brazil and China also agreed to establish the first pool of reserves of BRICs countries for $60 billion to ensure liquidity in the event of a crisis—a precursor of the subsequent BRICS CRA.[149]

In 2011, then–Russian President Dmitri Medvedev also supported including BRICS currencies in the IMF SDR, given Moscow's view of its prospects to be leaders of global development, despite the fact that BRICS currencies are not at present fully convertible or widely used in global trade or investment outside of some regional or bilateral trade settlement.[150] For example, some Indian trade with near neighbors is rupee-denominated and Indian multinationals may use the currency in financial operations with subsidiaries.

Meanwhile, China was actively promoting the use of national currencies in bilateral trade with several regional partners, including Japan, as well as the inclusion of the RMB in the SDR basket. The SDR goal reportedly was constantly discussed in 2011 at the G20. While the Europeans focused on the sovereign-debt crisis, the Chinese, as a major creditor, expected European reforms and the protection of their investments in euro debt. Into this mix, a French-Chinese working group was set up to study the question of integrating the RMB into the SDR.[151] That same year, PBOC authorities declared that